

Investigate the role of classification in ordering and organising the diversity of life on Earth and use and develop classification tools including dichotomous keys

Learning intention

- investigate the role of classification in ordering and organising the diversity of life on Earth and use and develop classification tools including dichotomous keys.

Teach and model

- using provided dichotomous keys to identify organisms surveyed on a field trip.
- considering the reasons for classifying living things, such as identification and communication.
- examining how biological classification has changed over time through improvements in microscopy.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.